

My digital agreement

A boundary written on paper is easier to keep than one held vaguely in mind. This page is for you; you never need to share it.

For my retreat from _____ to _____, I will use (tick one):

☐ **Option A • Remain reachable:** mobile service stays on, and Focus or Do Not Disturb allows calls only from _____.

☐ **Option B • Disconnect:** my phone stays off or in airplane mode. In an emergency, my contact will call _____, who can reach me in person at the retreat location and is available throughout, including overnight. (Optional: I will also check my phone at _____.)

I tested this arrangement on _____ (Option A: a real test call with the settings on; Option B: the person nearby confirmed they can receive the call and reach me).

My emergency contact is _____, and we have agreed what counts as an emergency.

I have told _____, _____ and _____ that I am unavailable.

I will read Scripture on _____ and the session pages on _____.

I will not post about the retreat while it is happening.

If I slip, I will put the phone down and return to what I was doing, without guilt.

Signed: _____ Date: _____

What counts as an emergency (agree it together, out loud)

A serious health or safety problem · an urgent issue with a dependant · something that truly cannot wait. Not ordinary questions, routine work decisions, or matters someone else can resolve.

BEFORE YOU LEAVE

Prepare the device

- ☐ Download the Bible, the session pages, maps, any music and emergency information for offline use
- ☐ Turn off notification badges and lock-screen previews
- ☐ Remove social-media and email apps from the home screen, or sign out for now
- ☐ Turn off smartwatch notifications
- ☐ Write essential contacts and emergency numbers on paper
- ☐ Save the retreat address
- ☐ Pack a charger or power bank
- ☐ Test the emergency arrangement
- ☐ Tell your emergency contact when the boundary begins and ends

As you prepare

1. My honest reaction to the thought of several days without my phone (without judging it):

2. How will I read Scripture and the session pages? If on my phone, what will make that workable?

3. The packing checklist (next page): which missing items are essential? Will I buy, borrow, substitute, download, or decide I do not need them?

4. Is there anything on the "leave behind" list I am reluctant to leave? What am I afraid will happen if I do not bring it?

The packing checklist

Items marked optional are just that.

Sessions and reflection

- ☐ Bible, printed or prepared
- ☐ The session pages, printed or downloaded
- ☐ Journal (or an offline alternative) and two pens
- ☐ Your Lesson 4 check-in, Lesson 7 intention and Lesson 8 notes
- ☐ Timer or watch
- ☐ Index cards or loose paper
- ☐ Something that helps you settle (optional)

Medication and health

- ☐ All regular medication, with extra
- ☐ Prescriptions, supplies or devices
- ☐ Essential medical information, accessible in an emergency
- ☐ Glasses, hearing aids, mobility aids and other equipment

Clothing and sleep

- ☐ Layered clothes for the season
- ☐ Walking shoes
- ☐ Pillow, earplugs, eye mask (optional)
- ☐ Outdoor items: sunscreen, hat, repellent, rain protection, first-aid kit

Personal care

- ☐ Toothbrush, toothpaste, soap, deodorant
- ☐ Towel, if not provided
- ☐ Menstrual products, if needed

A paper card to carry

Address where I am staying · emergency contact · host or property · my doctor · the emergency number for this country

Food and water

- ☐ Simple food that meets your needs (see Lesson 10)
- ☐ Refillable water bottle

Safety, communication and transport

- ☐ Phone, prepared and tested
- ☐ Charger and power bank
- ☐ Paper card: address, emergency contact, host, doctor, emergency number
- ☐ Identification and booking details
- ☐ Cash or card
- ☐ Transport confirmed both ways

Location-specific

- ☐ Bedding and towels, if not provided
- ☐ Cooking equipment, if self-catering
- ☐ Keys or entry code

Leave behind

- ☐ Work and work devices
- ☐ Unfinished projects (finished, delegated or rescheduled)
- ☐ Extra books
- ☐ Objects that create pressure
- ☐ Guilt about leaving, named (Lesson 2)